Food for the Sea

A.k.a. "Swordfish"

A **"Delta Green"** Module
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Briefing:

Anton Alvarez has been going out to the ocean at night. After his most recent business venture, Anton rested at the Sundown Motel between the airport and his hometown of Camaron. When returning in the morning, his 19-year-old daughter, Lucia, claims that Anton isn't acting like himself; "*Sweaty, looking ill, strained vocal chords, and quite confused.*". On top of this, Lucia has taken note of Anton walking out to La Jolla beach at 11:58pm. She has noticed this about four days ago, but believes he may have been doing this routine since he returned home.

Two other similar incidents have been made known:
Madelaine Torres and Murphy Wayne. Both locals of Camaron, both took respite at the Sundown Motel, both reported venturing out to La Jolla beach at night, and both now dead.

These incidents caught Delta Green's attention when autopsies reported identical obscure masses in their stomachs and body decay further along than reported day of death.

Find the cause, report, and neutralize if you can. Destroy all evidence - if there is any doubt or backup needed, call: **47336.**

What's Going On:

In recent years, company **Chem-Ex** has been dumping toxic waste into La Jolla beach. This has rapidly mutated some common mussels into what Dr. Santiago has dubbed: Jackerfish.

Dr. Santiago has worked previously for Chem-Ex and is largely to blame for the unforeseen mutation. He quit Chem-Ex 3 years ago when he realized the toxic waste may be more harmful than originally thought, and created a makeshift laboratory in the "Fire Husk Lighthouse" on La Jolla beach. He has been working to understand the Jackerfish, see if they can thrive peacefully in any environment, or if they must be killed.

The Jackerfish are highly fortified fish that are the size of a closed fist. When people drift out into the water at La Jolla beach, there's a chance one of these fish may find their way into their rectum and push themselves through the colon and into the small intestine, where they will expand like a puffer fish, destroying the digestive system and causing a painful death for their now **host.** Within their hosts, the Jackerfish will need to feed their carnivorous appetite: and resort to a form of cannibalism.

The Jackerfish extends thin tendrils up around the hosts spine to operate the nervous system and replicate the movements and vocalizations of a human.Once the hosts body decays beyond use, the Jackerfish must expel themselves out the way they came and find a new host - or die with the body. The average lifespan of a host is 1 week maximum.

The Jackerfish don't discriminate between their victims, anyone can be a host. While they can reside in their hosts body for up to 20 hours, they must return to the water to rehydrate nightly. All Jackerfish and their hosts congregate just beyond the docks of La Jolla beach, in Dunger Cove, to refresh and sometimes bring out new potential hosts.

Investigation:

The Alvarez' Home

Lucia Alvarez will greet and discuss the recent events with the Agents:

- Her father, **Anton**, was invited night swimming at the beginning of the week - when he stayed at **Sundown Motel** - by his friend **Bobby Pinto** (blond, goatee, tall, hawaiian shirts). Every day since, Anton has talked minimally, hasn't shared any meals with Lucia, even when she cooks for the both of them.
- Anton appears sick, and his appearance worses daily, but his demeanor and behaviors don't change. He smells terrible and won't wash or change his clothes.
- Anton walks out to **La Jolla** beach every night around midnight - it's a 15 minute walk from their house.

When the Agents arrive, Anton will be in the bathroom, sitting idly in an empty bathtub wearing soaking wet dirty clothes. Anton looks like a corpse but will keep his eyes trained on the Agents and respond with as few words as possible to any of their questions - otherwise mostly inquiring if they have any food for him.

If Agents try to apprehend him or harm him, Anton will attack and attempt to eat them.

The Morgue

Madelaine Torres and **Murphy Wayne** are in a couple of ice boxes in the morgue on Daxon St. Both of them appear rotted and dead a week prior to their reported time of discovery.

Records show that witness statements (by **Nan Gerble**) claim they saw both Madelaine and Murphy walking around in their home and around La Jolla beach the day before their deaths.

- Autopsy reports state that both victims died of "intestinal distress" equivalent to having a car run over their stomachs. There is no clear damage to their bodies, other than their anus where there appears to be notable tearing damage. They also appear to have some bloating.
- X-Rays show an unknown mass in their stomachs causing bloating and major damage to their body works that likely lead to their deaths. X-Rays also show scratches and distress along the spine from a material like a dog hairbrush.

- If Agents attempt to investigate the bloating or dissect the body, they risk bursting the corpse of the **Jackerfish**, which would cause oily ichor to leak out of the corpse. On a successful surgery attempt, they can unveil the dead creature, but will not be able to identify it beyond an animal in the same family as an aquatic mussel.
- If they extract any blood or ichor from the Jackerfish, they will find trace chemicals matching products from **Chem-Ex**, specifically **Kepone**.

Chem-Ex

Chem-Ex is a surprisingly small company in Camaron with light security that makes cleaning products in their on-site lab. **Dr. Julia Harker** leads the programs and firmly denies any allegations of duping toxic waste from their products anywhere. If **Dr. Santiago** is mentioned, Dr. Harker will remorsefully state that he left to do environmental work on La Jolla beach in the lighthouse.

None of the other workers will be able to confirm much about the toxic waste allegations, as they are at risk of losing their jobs if they break their NDA. They will need strong convincing to give up any information, or confirmation, of toxic wasting from Chem-Ex.

Sundown Motel

Nan Gerble, a stout smoker woman, runs the Sundown Motel. Their primary clientele are traveling sales people and low-level felons, but she doesn't discriminate. When asked about Anton, Madelaine, or Murphy, Nan will request some form of police ID or bribery before giving out information. If offered, she will answer:

- All 3 stayed at the Sundown Motel within the past few weeks and were fine residents while staying. Anton and Madelaine seemed to be out on business, Murphy was staying with a hooker named **Kacey**.
- One night while Nan was smoking outside, she saw that Anton was visited by a blond man with a goatee and a dirty hawaiian shirt (Bobby Pinto). Anton went out towards La Jolla beach with him and stumbled back to the motel, "probably drunk". His daughter came to pick him up the next morning.
- Nan doesn't know as much about Madelaine or Murphy, only that they also went out to La Jolla frequently during their stay at Sundown before their deaths.
- The hooker that Murphy was with, Kacey, is still staying at the hotel in room 113.

If Agents choose to investigate Kacey, they will discover her in room 113: taken over by a Jackerfish, and eating the meaty upper half of a client of hers. The corpse of Bobby Pinto and the Jackerfish inside of him will be lying on the floor next to the bed.

If Agents make noise or try to intervene, Kacey will attack and try to eat them.

Fire Husk Lighthouse

Dr. Santiago has turned the bottom floor of the lighthouse into an office laboratory, complete with chemistry table, black board, filing cabinets bursting at the seems, and several jars of Jackerfish corpses and preserved human intestines.

Dr. Santiago will be open about the toxic waste incidents - that to cut costs and to avoid negative publicity, they dumped toxic byproduct from their products into the beach in secret which ended up mutating mussels & barnacles into Jackerfish. While doing this, he will feverishly insist that he has it under control and is close to figuring out how to humanely relocate them.

It requires:

- Waiting until they convene in **Dunger Cove** at night.
- Trapping them and tranquilizing them with a small enough dose not to kill them.
- Piling them into a shipping container large enough for all of them and fast enough to move them before they need rehydration in 20 hours.

La Jolla Beach

During the day, La Jolla beach is a very family-friendly environment with lots of people tanning and swimming with no issue - you can even see fishing boats a good ways out in the water. If anyone swims to Dunger Cove, however, they will not come out.

During the night La Jolla is closed off, but that doesn't stop younger folk and Jackerfish host from breaking in and swimming out into the water.

Robert Fleming, an old and prominent fisherman of Camaron knows little of Dr. Santiago's, only that he is trying to save the Jackerfish and that the Jackerfish are dangerous.

Robert wants the fish out of La Jolla and doesn't care if he needs to offer his biggest boat to help Santiago ship them out somewhere else, or help find a way to kill them all. He can be easily convinced to captain his boat with the Agents and/or Santiago on board.

Dunger Cove

During the day, all Jackerfish can be found sleeping in Dunger Cove. Roll 4d6 to determine how many reside in the cave.

During the night, all hosts of Jackerfish will make the 4-minute swim out to Dunger Cove with 1d4 victims. Roll 2d6 to determine how many Jackerfish have hosts.

Jackerfish won't be easily spooked off, they are a mostly dazed creature - unsure of much of anything but their need to eat and hydrate.

The entrance to Dunger Cove is too small for any of Robert's boats, but may be large enough for a canoe. A canoe will warrant immediate suspicion from the Jackerfish, but swimming in will offer a better chance of entering undetected.

The hosts will be flopped over on the stone, clothes wet, skin loose, eyes open - like a corpse. They won't react unless provoked or a loud enough noise is made. The Jackerfish without hosts will be actively attempting to take over however many victims were lured out to Dunger Cove, including the Agents if they don't climb onto the surrounding stone quickly.

Any agent or individual in water is in immediate danger of the Jackerfish - the hosts will not be an issue unless they or their companions are antagonized directly.

Dunger Cove is a 30W x 50L x 25H area - there's not much room for the Jackerfish to escape - especially if the entrance is blocked by a net, or something equivalent.

Agents can attempt to move the Jackerfish into a net or container of sorts to begin the process of moving them elsewhere - or find a way to eliminate them.

Any hosts are already dead - the direct attack of Jackerfish on hosts will not save them.

Aftermath:

The Agent determine wether they attack or preserve the Jackerfish. They are encouraged to attempt to destroy all evidence, including:

- Anton Alvarez (0/1d4 SAN check)or (0/1d10 Violence SAN check)
- The Jackerfish within Madelaine & Murphy (0/1d4 SAN check)or (0/1d10 Violence SAN check)
- Santiago's Lab
    - At least 1 preserved Jackerfish is to be saved for Delta green to study. If one cannot be salvaged, another should be recovered.
- Kacey (0/1d4 SAN check)or (0/1d10 Violence SAN check)

Anton didn't have a will drafted, so one will be made that transfers his money to Lucia, and she will live with her aunt Francisca and cousin Julian.

Madelaine & Murphy's families have already been told they have died of a drug overdose.

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People:

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- Lucia Alvarez
- Madelaine Torres
- Murphy Wayne
- Dr. Kendall Santiago
- Dr. Julia Harker
- Nan Gerble
- Bobby Pinto
- Kacey Orin
- Robert Fleming
- The Jackerfish

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